left it. The next day I went to Petersburg to look up Gladys Credo. She was Robert Credo's wife; she was the one who knew the senator. She had gotten work at Petersburg to be with Bob while he was at Camp Lee and she had kept her job there while he was gone. I felt it was my duty to report to her on events (and to get her to tell me I hadn't done the wrong thing to get out of it when circumstances allowed me to).

She turned out to be a very attractive woman with whom it was a pleasure to talk. I told her about the fourteen weeks we specialists had shared together, and dredged up every story involving Bob that I could remember. The time passed pleasantly, and I saw her a few more times thereafter.

On June 24, I found out what had happened to my application for discharge. It had made its way to Washington and had been placed in suspended animation because I was being placed in an assignment that would utilize my research abilities "to the full." That referred, of course, to Operation Crossroads, which, in all the time I was assigned to it, made no use, not a scrap, of any research abilities of mine, and would not have done so if I had remained with it to the end.

My next step was to avoid being reassigned to something that would continue the suspended animation. I therefore went to Kriegman and asked him to have me assigned to his staff as typist. In that way I would be pinned to Camp Lee and could continue my moves. Kriegman pulled the necessary strings and once again I was off details as of June 27.

On June 30, the first of the two atom bombs was dropped at Bikini. I read about it in the newspapers and, in contrast, Camp Lee seemed rather tolerable to me.

I had a seventh furlough over the July 4 weekend, and on Sunday, July 7, I negotiated the trip from New York to Camp Lee for the seventh time.

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On July 11, I finally had my discharge hearing. I went in with many a pat on the back and many a grinning remark that no one at Camp Lee had ever been discharged at his own request. At other camps, maybe, but never at Camp Lee, which was a real "chicken outfit."

The interview lasted fifteen minutes, during which I did my best to appear quiet and reserved. I explained the nature of my research at Columbia, why I had ceased doing research (there was no question but that at the Navy Yard I